

Your geyser is making strange noises?

Here's what the popping and rumbling sounds could potentially mean

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It's a cold winter morning, and you've switched on your geyser a few minutes before taking a bath so the water is ready when you need it. While waiting, you hear a popping or rumbling sound coming from the bathroom. You might ignore it the first time, assuming it's just the geyser heating water, but if the noise keeps returning every time you switch it on, it's worth finding out what's causing it. Sediment buildup, scale on the heating element and bad plumbing can all make a geyser noisy.

Here's what could be causing the noise and when you should get your geyser checked.

Sediment buildup in the tank

Minerals present in hard water can gradually settle at the bottom of a storage geyser. As these deposits accumulate, they can interfere with heat transfer. Water trapped beneath the sediment may heat up and form steam bubbles, producing popping or rumbling sounds.

What to do: If the noise persists, first and foremost, you need to ask a qualified technician to inspect the tank and clean it if necessary. The frequency of maintenance depends totally on the overall water quality, usage and the manufacturer's recommendations and guidelines.

Scale on the heating element

If you live in an area with hard water, your geyser's heating element can develop a layer of scale over time. As the deposits build up, you may hear a crackling or popping sound whenever the geyser heats water. The water may also take longer to heat, particularly if the buildup has become heavy.

What to do: Get a technician to check the heating element and clean it if scale has built up. If the element is damaged, it may need replacement. Avoid opening the geyser yourself.

Water pressure or plumbing problems

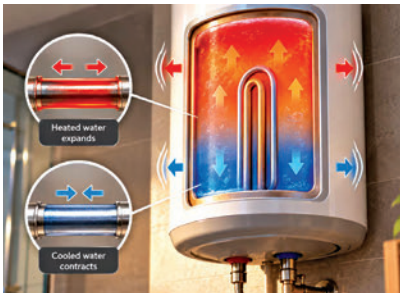
Sometimes, the noise does not originate inside the geyser at all. Loose pipes, faulty valves or changes in water pressure can cause vibrations, knocking or rumbling sounds.

If you hear the noise when opening a hot-water tap or when water starts flowing through the pipes, the plumbing could be responsible.

What to do: Get the pipework and relevant valves inspected by a plumber. Never disable or adjust the pressure-relief valve to stop the noise, as it is an important safety component.

Thermal expansion and contraction

Geysers and their connected pipes expand as they heat up and contract as they cool down. This movement can produce occasional clicking, ticking or light knocking sounds.



Such noises are not necessarily signs of a fault, particularly when they occur as the appliance starts heating or cools after use. However, loud or persistent banging should not automatically be attributed to thermal expansion.

What to do: Observe when the noise occurs. If it becomes louder or is accompanied by leaks or changes in heating performance, arrange a professional inspection.

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